

History

U.S.





About the Course

Get to know the diverse people who inhabited North America before Columbus arrived. Learn how they used what was available around them for food, shelter, clothing, and protection. Observe their customs and hear their stories.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
1	History: Grade 1 (U.S.) 1 time/week 10 min	Frozen Land Hiawatha and the Peacemaker Itse Selu: Cherokee Harvest Festival Moonstick: The Seasons of the Sioux Tales the Totems Tell The Book of Indians The Very First Americans

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grade 1 (U.S.)				
	History: Grade 1 (U.S.)			



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

History: Grade 1 (U.S.)

☐ NOTE: Hiawatha & the Peacemaker contains some illustrations that sensitive children may find scary; however, this book is very important, as it tells the traditional legend of how the Iroquois Confederacy (which heavily influenced the American Founding Fathers) was formed. Preview the book and decide if there are pictures you would rather your student(s) not see.

☐ Go through the lessons and decide if you want to print the images provided in the links. Store these with lesson plans for easy access.

☐ Number the pages (starting with the first page of text) in The Very First Americans, Frozen Land, Moonstick, Hiawatha & The Peacemaker, and Itse Selu.

☐ Print the PDFs linked below in Quick Links for Tales the Totems Tell and The Book of Indians, Chapter IX.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

History: Grade 1 (U.S.)



Frozen Land



Hiawatha and the Peacemaker



Itse Selu: Cherokee Harvest Festival



Moonstick: The Seasons of the Sioux



Tales the Totems Tell



The Book of Indians



The Very First Americans



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

History: Grade 1 (U.S.)

∞ [Tales the Totems Tell](#)

∞ [The Book of Indians](#)

∞ [Outdoor Work](#)

[Click THIS text](#)
[or scan the QR](#)
[code for links.](#)



History: Grade 1 (U.S.)

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.



Recap

- Connect to previous lessons by asking students to recall where they left off.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the previous lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the student's pace for the lesson time rather than a particular number of pages. It is vitally important that teachers not try to 'force feed' a student more than they can consume in one sitting.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.

- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question.

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Term 1

WEEK 1 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 1

The First Americans

Materials: The Very First Americans, Globe

→ INTRO

Point to Iraq (Tigris and Euphrates Rivers) on a globe. This is where the Garden of Eden is believed to have been. From there, where could people spread out and walk as the population grew? Point to North America. Could they walk here? How do you think they might have gotten here?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1 "Long, long ago" - "The name stuck."

→ LOCATE

Find the Bering Strait on the globe.

• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons.

WEEK 2 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 2

People of the Tundra

Materials: Frozen Land, Globe

→ RECAP

What do you remember from what we read last time?

→ INTRO

When the first people came to America, some stayed in the frozen north (see picture). Humans need food, water, shelter, and clothing to survive. How might you get these things if you lived here? Find the Hudson Bay on a globe. This is where our story takes place. Is it near where you live?
∞ Image Link: Frozen Tundra

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-8 "As the sun" - "be a fish."

★ TEACHER TIP

Students should also be encouraged to narrate using Legos, puppets, or by acting out the scene.

WEEK 3 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 3

Caribou and Other Animals

Materials: Frozen Land

→ INTRO

What kinds of animals do you think live near Kenalogak? What do you think they might eat?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.9-16 "Kenalogak loves" - "the wolf skin."

• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK - Prompt in Outdoor Work Quick Link: Go to a natural area near your home. Imagine you are a Native American living in that place. Notice what is around you. How would you find or make food, water, shelter, and clothing so you could survive?

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Term 1

WEEK 4 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 4

Making an Igloo

Materials: Frozen Land

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the Inuit?

→ INTRO

What do you like to do when you spend time with your grandparents? Are there any special stories or songs they like to share? Today, Kenalogak's grandparents are coming for a visit.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.17-27 "Playing outside" - "snow and ice."

WEEK 5 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 5

The Owl and the Lemming

→ INTRO

This is a "trickster tale" from the Eskimo/Inuit people. Lots of cultures have these kinds of stories. In the video, you will hear Inuit language and music. See if you can figure out why this kind of story is called a "trickster tale."

→ VIEW & NARRATE

∞ Video Link: The Owl and the Lemming

● ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons.

★ TEACHER TIP

Students should also be encouraged to narrate using Legos, puppets, or by acting out the scene.

WEEK 6 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 6

People of the Pacific Northwest

Materials: The Very First Americans

→ INTRO

Not all of the first Americans stayed in the frozen north. Look at this picture. How is the land different from where Kenalogak lives? What do you think people who settled here may have used for food, water, shelter, and clothing?

∞ Image Link: Pacific Northwest

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.3-8 "Tribes like the Chinook," - "rich he was."

★ TEACHER TIP

Remember to recap the previous lesson before starting the new lesson.

WEEK 7 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 7

Comparing Two Ways of Life

Materials: The Very First Americans

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Study the picture. Talk about some of the differences you notice between how these people live and how Kenalogak's family lives. If Kenalogak

● ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons.

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Term 1

came for a visit to this village, what might she find strange? If one of these children were to visit Kenalogak, what would she need to do differently to survive?

p.5-6

WEEK 8 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 8

Totem Poles

Materials: Globe

→ INTRO

Find British Columbia on a globe. Is it very close to Hudson Bay? Is it close to where you live? The people we will learn about today live here.

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

In this video, we learn about totem poles and other parts of the culture of the Pacific Northwest Tribes.

∞ Video Link: Pacific Northwest People

● ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons. Try illustrating a totem pole.

WEEK 9 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 9

Totem Poles

Materials: Tales the Totems Tell (PDF)

∞ PDF Link: Tales the Totems Tell

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The First Totem Pole" p.1-9

"When Ramlaryaelk" - "the totem pole."

★ TEACHER TIP

Remember to recap the previous lesson before starting the new lesson.

WEEK 10 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 10

Totem Poles (cont.)

Materials: Tales the Totems Tell (PDF)

∞ PDF Link: Tales the Totems Tell

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The Raven and the Indians" p.10-17

"Of all the" - "touched the moon."

● ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons.

★ TEACHER TIP

Students should also be encouraged to narrate using Legos, puppets, or by acting out the scene.

WEEK 11 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 11

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

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Term 1

WEEK 12 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course. If a book was not finished during the term, adjust the exam questions to reflect what was read or allow students to tell about or draw from stories or excerpts that they remember. If a student has difficulty getting started or gets "stuck," they may look back at illustrations to help them refocus on ideas.

Questions will come from:

The Very First Americans, Frozen Land, Tales the Totems Tell

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Term 2

WEEK 1 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 13

People of the Southwest

Materials: The Very First Americans

→ INTRO

How is the place in this picture different from the Pacific Northwest? If your Tribe lived here, how could you get food, water, shelter, and clothing? The tall rock formation that is flat on top is called a "mesa," which means "table" in Spanish.

∞ Image Link: Desert Mesa

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.9-12 "The hot, dry" - "with the rain."

• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons. Try illustrating a mesa.

WEEK 2 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 14

Comparing Two Ways of Life

Materials: The Very First Americans

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Study the picture and tell what you notice. How are these people similar to the ones in the Pacific Northwest? How are they different? Count how many clay pots you see. Why do you think these people made pots of clay instead of boxes of wood for holding things? Find something that has been decorated with a design. How are the designs different from the designs used in the Pacific Northwest?

p.9-10, 5-8

WEEK 3 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 15

People of the Mesas

Materials: The Book of Indians (PDF)

∞ PDF Link: The Book of Indians

→ INTRO

This is a story about a little boy who lives in the Southwest. One thing we have not read about yet is what these people ate. Listen for types of food.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Little-Turtle of the Cliff Dwellers" Ch.IX p.81-83

"Little-Turtle" - "time will tell."

★ TEACHER TIP

Remember to recap the previous lesson before starting the new lesson.

WEEK 4 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 16

People of the Mesas (cont.)

Materials: The Book of Indians (PDF)

∞ PDF Link: The Book of Indians

→ INTRO

What foods do you remember Little-Turtle's people eating? Where do you

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Term 2

think the people of the mesa got their water? Listen today for several sources.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Little-Turtle of the Cliff Dwellers" Ch.IX p.83-85

"When Uncle Antelope" - "out of the canyon."

WEEK 5 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 17

People of the Mesas (cont.)

 Materials: The Book of Indians (PDF)

∞ PDF Link: The Book of Indians

→ INTRO

Do you remember what was happening when we left off?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Little-Turtle of the Cliff Dwellers" Ch.IX p.85-88

"How odd," - "saved his people."

● ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons.

★ TEACHER TIP

Students should also be encouraged to narrate using Legos, puppets, or by acting out the scene.

WEEK 6 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 18

People of the Plains & Prairies

 Materials: The Very First Americans, Globe

→ INTRO

The Great Plains is a huge region that cuts right through the middle of the United States. Find it on a map or globe. Do you live here? Look at the picture and think about the Native Americans who lived there. What might they use for food, water, shelter, and clothing?

∞ Image Link: The Great Plains

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.13-18 "Long ago," - "rolled-up hair."

★ TEACHER TIP

Remember to recap the previous lesson before starting the new lesson.

WEEK 7 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 19

Comparing Ways of Life

 Materials: The Very First Americans

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Look at the pictures. Tell all you notice. Why did tipis work well for these people? Would they have worked as well on the mesa, in the Northwest, or in the tundra? What designs and decorations do you notice? Look at the women cooking. One woman is heating a stone in the fire. When it is hot, she will drop it in the "pot" to cook the food. What do you suppose the pot is made of?

p.13-18

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Term 2

WEEK 8 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 20

Keeping Time: Moons

Materials: Moonstick: The Seasons of the Sioux

→ INTRO

How many months are in a year? Can you say them all? Native Americans had their own way of marking time using what they observed in nature. One "moon" was the time from one full moon to the next. How many moons do you think there are in a year? Read the last page to find out.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-8 "Moon of the Birth of Calves" - "Moon of the Ripe Juneberries"

WEEK 9 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 21

Keeping Time: Moons (cont.)

Materials: Moonstick: The Seasons of the Sioux

→ INTRO

Do you remember how Native Americans named each moon? If you were going to name the moon you are in now, according to what is happening in nature, what name might you choose?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.9-16 "Cherry-Ripening Moon" - "Moon of the Falling Leaves"

★ TEACHER TIP

Remember to recap the previous lesson before starting the new lesson.

WEEK 10 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 22

Keeping Time: Moons (cont.)

Materials: Moonstick: The Seasons of the Sioux

→ INTRO

Look back at the pictures so far. Which seasons have you seen?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.17-24 "Moon of the Hairless Calves" - "Sore-Eyes Moon"

● ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons.

★ TEACHER TIP

Students should also be encouraged to narrate using Legos, puppets, or by acting out the scene.

WEEK 11 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 23

Keeping Time: Moons (cont.)

Materials: Moonstick: The Seasons of the Sioux

→ INTRO

Native Americans still live in the USA. What are some ways you think their lives may have changed?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.25-30 "Moon When the Grass Comes Up" - "it is so arranged."

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Term 2

WEEK 12 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course. If a book was not finished during the term, adjust the exam questions to reflect what was read or allow students to tell about or draw from stories or excerpts that they remember. If a student has difficulty getting started or gets "stuck," they may look back at illustrations to help them refocus on ideas.

Questions will come from:

The Very First Americans, The Book of Indians (Ch.IX), Moonstick

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Term 3

WEEK 1 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 25

People of the Woodlands

Materials: The Very First Americans

→ INTRO

East of the Great Plains, the USA was once covered in forest. How do you think life in the forest might have been different from life in the desert or on the plains?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.19-22 "The Delaware," - "on their prey."

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Look at the picture. How do these people appear similar to and different from others you have read about?

WEEK 2 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 26

The Iroquois Confederacy

Materials: Hiawatha and the Peacemaker

PREP: Read "Historical Note" on p.43.

→ INTRO

Point to the Great Lakes on a map or globe. This story takes place on the eastern shores, where there were five Tribes who were constantly at war with one another.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-10 "A fierce scream" - "great Peacemaker."

★ TEACHER TIP

Remember to recap the previous lesson before starting the new lesson.

WEEK 3 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 27

The Iroquois Confederacy (cont.)

Materials: Hiawatha and the Peacemaker

→ INTRO

Can you remember what was happening when we left off?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.11-18 "I stared at" - "as two nations."

WEEK 4 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 28

The Iroquois Confederacy (cont.)

Materials: Hiawatha and the Peacemaker

→ INTRO: WHAT IS "FORGIVENESS?" HAVE YOU EVER FORGIVEN OR BEEN FORGIVEN BY SOMEONE? HOW DID IT MAKE YOU FEEL?

● ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons.

★ TEACHER TIP

Students should also be encouraged to narrate using

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Term 3

	→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.19-28 "Guided by the moon" - "as four nations."	Legos, puppets, or by acting out the scene.
WEEK 5	📅 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 29 <i>The Iroquois Confederacy (cont.)</i> 📄 Materials: Hiawatha and the Peacemaker → INTRO What do you think is going to happen when they meet Tadodaho? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.29-36 "The wicked" - "where they belonged."	
WEEK 6	📅 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 30 <i>The Iroquois Confederacy (cont.)</i> 📄 Materials: Hiawatha and the Peacemaker → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.37-42 "Everyone followed" - "tree of peace." → DISCUSS Share a little from the Historical Note on p.43, particularly that the United States' Founding Fathers were influenced by the Iroquois Confederacy when they were setting up our government.	• ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons.
WEEK 7	📅 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 31 <i>The Cherokee</i> 📄 Materials: Itse Selu PREP: Read the Preface. → INTRO Far south of the Great Lakes, where it is not so cold, the Cherokee lived. Find the Blue Ridge Mountains on a map or globe. This was their home before people came from Europe. Do you live near here? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.1-8 "Little Wolf blinked" - "her work done."	★ TEACHER TIP Remember to recap the previous lesson before starting the new lesson.
WEEK 8	📅 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 32 <i>The Cherokee (cont.)</i> 📄 Materials: Itse Selu → INTRO Look at the pictures on p.2 of Itse Selu and p.18 of The Very First Americans. How are the cooking methods similar? How are they different?	

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Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.9-18 "Little Wolf gobbled" - "stop rolling."

WEEK 9 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 33

The Cherokee (cont.)

Materials: Itse Selu

→ INTRO

Does your family have a special tradition to celebrate the New Year? Today's reading is about a very special Cherokee New Year's tradition, including a trickster tale. Do you remember what that means?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.19-28 "The late afternoon" - "Happy New Year."

● ILLUSTRATE - Draw the story of the clever rabbit and the foolish wildcat (p.23) using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons.

★ TEACHER TIP

Students should also be encouraged to narrate using Legos, puppets, or by acting out the scene.

WEEK 10 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 34

Comparing Cultures

→ DISCUSS

Both the Iroquois and the Cherokee Tribes lived in the forest. How were their appearances similar and different? What about their houses and clothing? Look back through the pictures of your books and talk about how each group of people used the materials that were available to them for food, water, shelter, and clothing. Which group lived nearest you?

WEEK 11 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 35

The Coming of the Europeans

Materials: The Very First Americans

→ INTRO

The native people lived as the stories/books we've read described for many years. Then something happened that would change their way of life forever. What do you think it was?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.23-29 "Most woodlands" - "very first Americans."

★ TEACHER TIP

Remember to recap the previous lesson before starting the new lesson.

WEEK 12 10m History: Grade 1 (U.S.) - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course. If a book was not finished during the term, adjust the exam questions to reflect what was read or allow students to tell about or draw from stories or excerpts that they remember. If a student has difficulty getting started or gets "stuck," they may look back at illustrations to help them refocus on ideas.

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Term 3

Questions will come from:

The Very First Americans, Hiawatha and the Peacemaker, Itse Selu

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Examination

Term 1

- Frozen Land: Tell about the people of the Frozen Tundra.
- OR
- The Very First Americans: Tell about the people of the Pacific Northwest.
- Tell about or draw the story of the Owl and the Lemming.
- OR
- Tales the Totem Tells: Tell about or draw the story of the Raven and the Indians.

Term 2

- The Book of Indians: Tell about the people of the Mesas.
- OR
- The Very First Americans: Tell about the people of the Plains.
- Moonstick: The Seasons of the Sioux: Tell about or draw how Native Americans kept track of time.
- OR
- The Very First Americans: Tell about or draw how Native Americans used what was available to them for food, water, shelter, and clothing.

Term 3

- Hiawatha and the Peacemaker: Tell about or illustrate the story of Hiawatha and the Peacemaker.
- The Very First Americans: Tell about Woodland Tribes.
- OR
- Itse Selu: Cherokee Harvest Festival: Tell about the Cherokee Festival of Itse Selu.